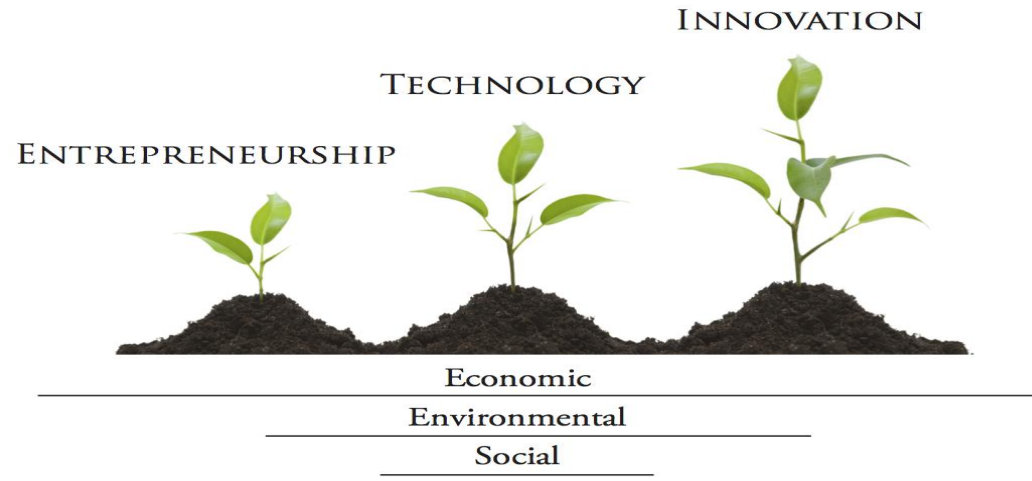




Entrepreneurship in IT

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Industry and Competitor Analysis

What is Industry Analysis?

Industry

- An industry is a group of firms producing a similar product or service, such as music, Pilates and yoga studios, and solar panel manufacturing.

Industry Analysis

- Is business research that focuses on the potential of an industry.

Why is Industry Analysis Important?

- Once it is determined that a new venture is feasible in regard to the industry and market in which it will compete, a more in-depth analysis is needed to learn the ins and outs of the industry.
- The analysis helps a firm determine if the target market it identified during feasibility analysis is favorable for a new firm.

Three Key Questions

When studying an industry, an entrepreneur must answer three questions before pursuing the idea of starting a firm.

- Question 1
 - Is the industry accessible—in other words, is it a realistic place for a new venture to enter?
- Question 2
 - Does the industry contain markets that are ripe for innovation or are underserved?
- Question 3
 - Are there positions in the industry that will avoid some of the negative attributes of the industry as a whole?

Techniques Available to Assess Industry Attractiveness

Studying industry trends and using the five forces model are two techniques entrepreneurs have available for assessing industry attractiveness.

- Study Environmental and Business Trends
- The Five Competitive Forces Model

Studying Industry Trends

Environmental Trends

- Include economic trends, social trends, technological advances, and political and regulatory changes.
- For example, industries that sell products to seniors are benefiting by the aging of the population.

Business Trends

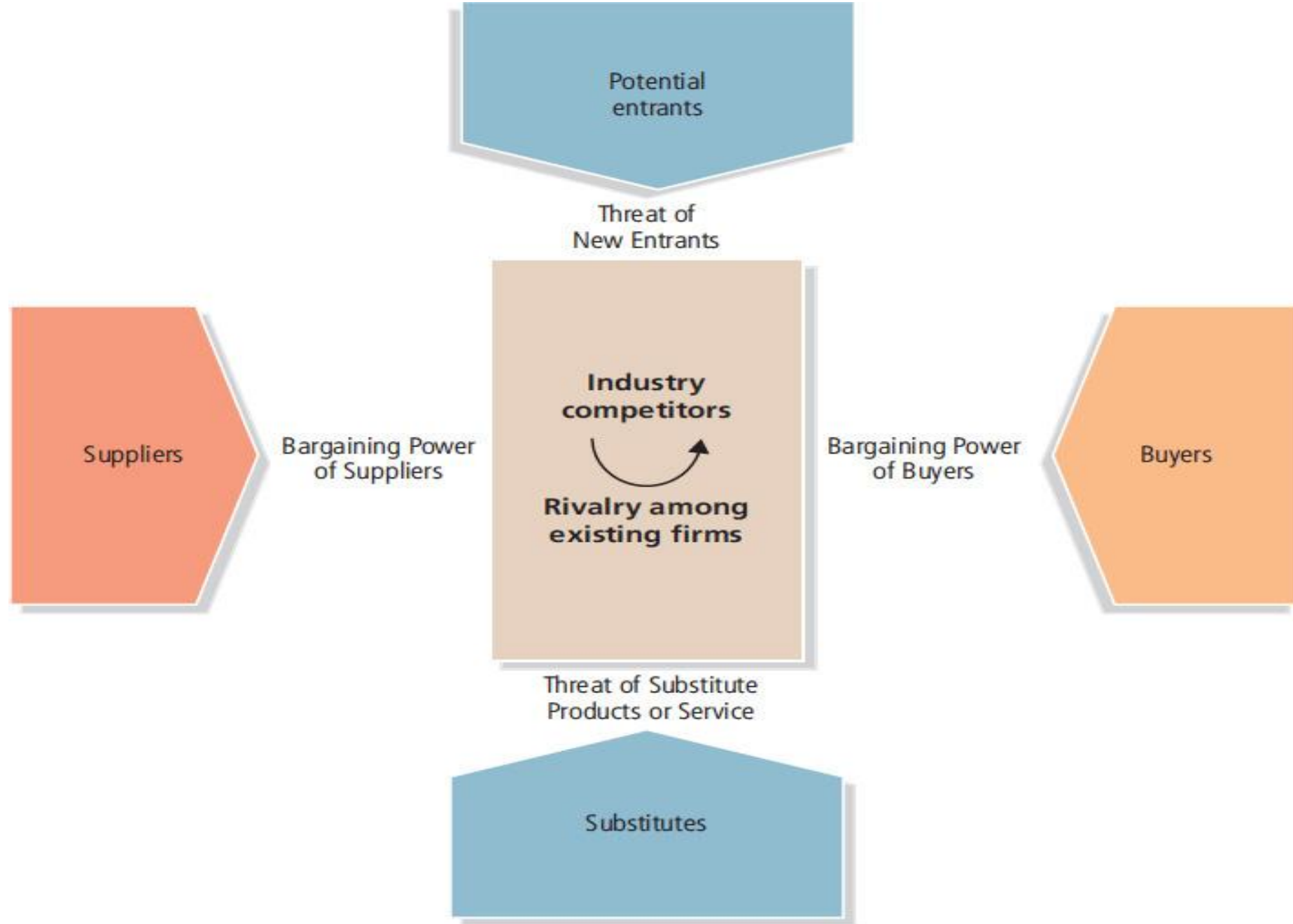
- Other trends that impact an industry.
- For example, are profit margins in the industry increasing or falling? Is innovation accelerating or waning? Are input costs going up or down?

The Five Forces Model (1 of 2)

- Developed by Michael Porter, the five competitive forces model is a framework for understanding the structure of an industry.
 - The model is composed of the forces that determine industry profitability:
 1. The threat of substitutes
 2. The threat of new entrants
 3. Rivalry among existing firms
 4. The bargaining power of suppliers
 5. The bargaining power of buyers

The Five Forces Model (2 of 2)

- Explanation of the Five Forces Model
 - Each of the five forces impacts the average rate of return for the firms in an industry by applying pressure on industry profitability.
 - Well-managed firms try to position their firms in a way that avoids or diminishes these forces—in an attempt to beat the average rate of return of the industry.



Threat of Substitutes (1 of 2)

In general, industries are more attractive when the threat of substitutes is low.

- This means that products from other industries cannot easily serve as substitutes for the products firms in a certain industry are manufacturing and selling.
 - For example, there are few, if any, substitutes for prescription medicines, which is one of the reasons the pharmaceutical industry is so profitable.
- In contrast, when close substitutes for a product exist, industry profitability is suppressed, because consumers will opt out if the price gets too high.

Threat of Substitutes (2 of 2)

- The extent to which substitutes suppress the profitability of an industry depends on the propensity for buyers to substitute between alternatives.
- This is why firms in an industry often offer their customers amenities to reduce the likelihood that they will switch to a substitute product, even in light of a price increase.
 - Starbucks experience

Threat of New Entrants (1 of 6)

- If the firms in an industry are highly profitable, the industry becomes a magnet to new entrants.
- Unless something is done to stop this, the competition in the industry will increase, and average industry profitability will decline.
- Firms in an industry try to keep the number of new entrants low by erecting barriers to entry.
 - A barrier to entry is a condition that creates a disincentive for a new firm to enter an industry.

Threat of New Entrants (2 of 6)

Barrier to Entry	Explanation
Economies of scale	Industries that are characterized by large economies of scale are difficult for new firms to enter, unless they are willing to accept a cost disadvantage.
Product differentiation	Industries such as the soft drink industry that are characterized by firms with strong brands are difficult to break into without spending heavily on advertising.
Capital requirements	The need to invest large amounts of money to gain entrance to an industry is another barrier to entry.

Threat of New Entrants (3 of 6)

Barrier to Entry	Explanation
Cost advantages independent of size	Existing firms may have cost advantages not related to size. For example, the existing firms in an industry may have purchased land when it was less expensive than it is today.
Access to distribution channels	Distribution channels are often hard to crack. This is particularly true in crowded markets, such as the convenience store market.
Government and legal barriers	Some industries, such as banking and broadcasting, require the granting of a license by a public authority to compete.

Threat of New Entrants (4 of 6)

Nontraditional Barriers to Entry

- It is difficult for startups to execute barriers to entry that are expensive, such as economies of scale, because money is usually tight.
- Startups have to rely on nontraditional barriers to entry to discourage new entrants, such as assembling a world-class management team that would be difficult for another company to replicate.

Threat of New Entrants (5 of 6)

Barrier to Entry	Explanation
Strength of management team	If a startup puts together a world-class management team, it may give potential rivals pause in taking on the startup in its chosen industry.
First-mover advantage	If a startup pioneers an industry or a new concept within an industry, the name recognition the startup establishes may create a barrier to entry.
Passion of the management team and employees	If the employees of a startup are motivated by the unique culture of a startup, and anticipate a large financial reward, this is a combination that cannot be replicated by larger firms.

Threat of New Entrants (6 of 6)

Barrier to Entry	Explanation
Unique business model	If a startup is able to construct a unique business model and establish a network of relationships that makes the business model work, this set of advantages creates a barrier to entry.
Internet domain name	Some Internet domain names are so “spot-on” that they give a startup a meaningful leg up in terms of e-commerce opportunities.
Inventing a new approach to an industry	If a startup invents a new approach to an industry and executes it in an exemplary fashion, these factors create a barrier to entry for potential imitators.

Rivalry Among Existing Firms (1 of 3)

- In most industries, the major determinant of industry profitability is the level of competition among existing firms.
- Some industries are fiercely competitive, to the point where prices are pushed below the level of costs, and industry-wide losses occur.
- In other industries, competition is much less intense and price competition is subdued.

Rivalry Among Existing Firms (2 of 3)

Factors that determine the intensity of the rivalry among existing firms in an industry

Number and balance of competitors	The more competitors there are, the more likely it is that one or more will try to gain customers by cutting its price.
Degree of difference between products	The degree to which products differ from one producer to another affects industry rivalry.

Rivalry Among Existing Firms (3 of 3)

Factors that determine the intensity of the rivalry among existing firms in an industry (continued)

Growth rate of an industry	The competition among firms in a slow-growth industry is stronger than among those in fast-growth industries.
Level of fixed costs	Firms that have high fixed costs must sell a higher volume of their product to reach the break-even point than firms with low fixed costs.

Bargaining Power of Suppliers (1 of 3)

- Suppliers can suppress the profitability of the industries to which they sell by raising prices or reducing the quality of the components they provide.
- If a supplier reduces the quality of the components it supplies, the quality of the finished product will suffer, and the manufacturer will eventually have to lower its price.
- If the suppliers are powerful relative to the firms in the industry to which they sell, industry profitability can suffer.

Bargaining Power of Suppliers (2 of 3)

Factors that have an impact on the ability of suppliers to exert pressure on buyers

Supplier concentration	When there are only a few suppliers that supply a critical product to a large number of buyers, the supplier has an advantage.
Switching costs	Switching costs are the fixed costs that buyers encounter when switching or changing from one supplier to another. If switching costs are high, a buyer will be less likely to switch suppliers.

Bargaining Power of Suppliers (3 of 3)

Factors that have an impact on the ability of suppliers to exert pressure on buyers
(continued)

Attractiveness of substitutes	Supplier power is enhanced if there are no attractive substitutes for the products or services the supplier offers.
Threat of forward integration	The power of a supplier is enhanced if there is a credible possibility that the supplier might enter the buyer's industry.

Bargaining Power of Buyers (1 of 3)

- Buyers can suppress the profitability of the industries from which they purchase by demanding price concessions or increases in quality.
 - For example, the automobile industry is dominated by a handful of large companies that buy products from thousands of suppliers in different industries. This allows the automakers to suppress the profitability of the industries from which they buy by demanding price reductions.

Bargaining Power of Buyers (2 of 3)

Factors that have an impact on the ability of buyers to exert pressure on suppliers

Buyer group concentration	If there are only a few large buyers, and they buy from a large number of suppliers, they can pressure the suppliers to lower costs and thus affect the profitability of the industries from which they buy.
Buyer's costs	The greater the importance of an item is to a buyer, the more sensitive the buyer will be to the price it pays.

Bargaining Power of Buyers (3 of 3)

Factors that have an impact on the ability of buyers to exert pressure on suppliers
(continued)

Degree of standardization of supplier's products	The degree to which a supplier's product differs from its competitors affects the buyer's bargaining power.
Threat of backward integration	The power of buyers is enhanced if there is a credible threat that the buyer might enter the supplier's industry.

The Value of the Five Forces Model (1 of 2)

- The five forces model can be used to assess the attractiveness of an industry by determining the level of threat to industry profitability for each of the forces.
- If a firm fills out the form shown on the next slide and several of the threats to industry profitability are high, the firm may want to reconsider entering the industry or think carefully about the position it would occupy.

Determining the Attractiveness of an Industry Using the Five Forces Model

Competitive Force	Threat to Industry Profitability		
	Low	Medium	High
Threat of substitutes			
Threat of new entrants			
Rivalry among existing firms			
Bargaining power of suppliers			
Bargaining power of buyers			

Instructions:

Step 1 Select an industry.

Step 2 Determine the level of threat to industry profitability for each of the forces (low, medium, or high).

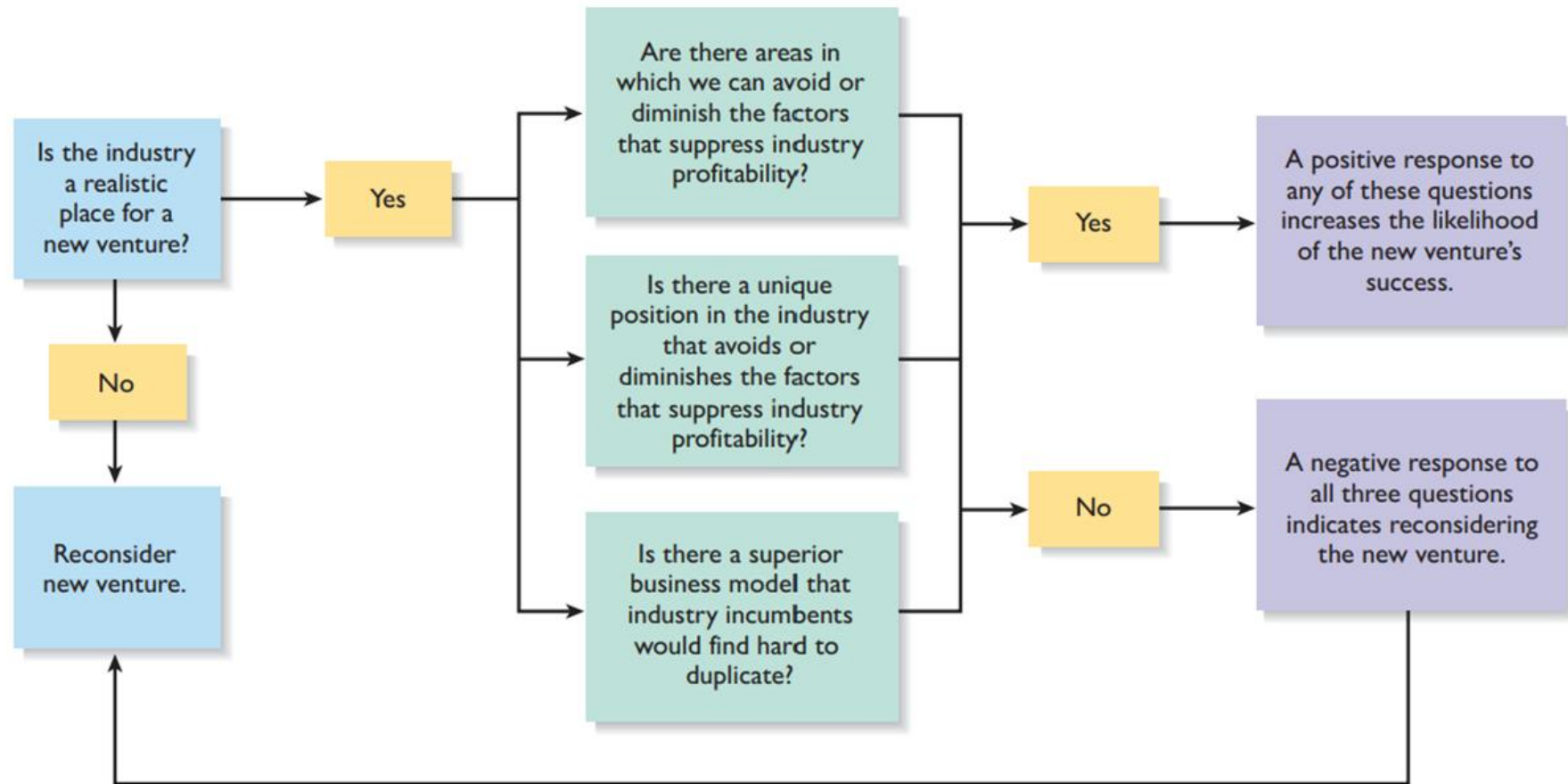
Step 3 Use the table to develop an overall feel for the attractiveness of the industry.

Step 4 Use the table to identify the threats that are most often relevant to industry profitability.

The Value of the Five Forces Model (2 of 2)

- The second way a new firm can apply the five forces model to help determine whether it should enter an industry is by using the model to answer several key questions.
- The questions, shown in the figure on the next slide, help a firm project the potential success of a new venture in a particular industry.

Using the Five Forces Model to Pose Questions to Determine the Potential Success of a New Venture



Industry Types and the Opportunities They Offer (1 of 2)

Emerging Industries

- Industries in which standard operating procedures have yet to be developed.
 - Opportunity: First-mover advantage.

Fragmented Industries

- Industries that are characterized by a large number of firms of approximately equal size.
 - Opportunity: Consolidation.

Mature Industries

- Industries that are experiencing slow or no increase in demand.
 - Opportunities: Process innovation and after-sale service innovation.

Industry Types and the Opportunities They Offer (2 of 2)

Declining Industries

- Industries that are experiencing a reduction in demand.
 - Opportunities: Leadership, establishing a niche market, and pursuing a cost reduction strategy.

Global Industries

- Industries that are experiencing significant international sales.
 - Opportunities: Multidomestic and global strategies.

Competitor Analysis

- A competitor analysis is a detailed analysis of a firm's competition.
- It helps a firm understand the positions of its major competitors and the opportunities that are available.
- A competitive analysis grid is a tool for organizing the information a firm collects about its competitors.

Types of Competitors New Ventures Face



Dropbox & Google Drive



Skype & Facebook



Sources of Competitive Intelligence (1 of 2)

Collecting Competitive Intelligence

- To complete a competitive analysis grid, a firm must first understand the strategies and behaviors of its competitors.
- The information that is gathered by a firm to learn about its competitors is referred to as competitive intelligence.
- A new venture should take care that it collects competitive intelligence in a professional and ethical manner.

Sources of Competitive Intelligence (2 of 2)

Ethical ways to obtain information about competitors

- Attend conferences and trade shows
- Purchase competitors' products
- Study competitors' websites and social media sites
- Set up Google Alerts
- Read industry-related books, magazines, and websites
- Talk to customers about what motivated them to buy your product as opposed to your competitor's product

Completing a Competitive Analysis Grid

Competitive Analysis Grid

- A tool for organizing the information a firm collects about its competitors.
- A competitive analysis grid can help a firm see how it stacks up against its competitors, provide ideas for markets to pursue, and identify its primary sources of competitive advantage.

Competitive Analysis Grid for Allbirds

Name	Allbirds	Nike	Brooks	New Balance	Sketchers
Price	Even	Even	Even	Even	Even
Selection	Disadvantage	Advantage	Even	Even	Even
Comfort	Advantage	Even	Even	Even	Advantage
Performance	Even	Even	Advantage	Advantage	Even
Design	Advantage	Even	Even	Even	Disadvantage
Cost structure	Disadvantage	Advantage	Even	Even	Even
Eco-friendly/sustainability	Advantage	Disadvantage	Disadvantage	Disadvantage	Disadvantage